RayMark

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Marketing and creative director pairing media strategy with hands-on creative for entertainment, hospitality, tech, and consumer brands. Led marketing for Cirque du Soleil ‘Auana ($47M+ in under two years) and paid media for Samsung’s Cannes Lions–winning campaigns at Starcom.

EXPERIENCE

Cirque du Soleil **Aug 2024 – Oct 2026**

Director of Marketing *Honolulu, HI*

- Led marketing for ‘Auana, Cirque du Soleil’s first resident show in Hawai‘i: 470K+ guests and $47M+ in ticket revenue across 868 performances in under two years.
- Owned a $2M+ annual sales, marketing, and communications budget against KPI and EBITDA targets with a lean local team, allocating spend across paid, partner, and on-property channels.
- Drove $1.9M in advance sales, topped the launch budget by 16%, and hit $25M in year one, ahead of budget.
- Grew visitor ticket sales 15% (+$960K) on 4% fewer shows by expanding in-market media; outdoor ad recall rose from 9% to 27%, the highest of any medium.
- Developed the ‘Auana brand guidelines and key visuals, directed photo and video shoots, and produced all ad creative and collateral in-house.
- Directed Japanese and Korean agencies; Japan became the largest international market ($4.5M+, +15% YoY) with the highest average ticket price.
- Built the kama‘āina (local) strategy: 119K+ tickets ($10.4M), Aloha Fridays ($530K+), and Pau Hana Partners, a no-cost dining and parking perk with five Waikīkī restaurants.
- Launched seasonal offers, including a $3M+ family program and a 24-hour July 4 BOGO that lifted a soft show from 33% to 67% occupancy, plus a $411K Black Friday/Cyber Monday.
- Marketed the soundtrack release with BMG, announced at the Aloha Tokyo Festival: 240K+ streams in 10 weeks and a 27% Apple Music save rate, 5x the industry benchmark.

WYD Agency **Jun 2016 – Aug 2024**

Co-founder & Creative Director *Honolulu, HI*

- Co-founded a boutique agency for start-ups and established brands, with work including Dolby keynotes and LeEco’s U.S. brand guidelines.
- Owned all creative across branding, web, packaging, and performance marketing, art-directing freelance designers, photographers, developers, and copywriters.
- Scaled Cannable, a California cannabis delivery start-up, from $2.9K to $176K in weekly sales in 13 months ($8.4M gross, 78K+ orders, 52% repeat customers).

Also Senior Director of Marketing, Lights On Digital (May – Dec 2023):

- Managed client services, creative, and performance marketing for luxury boutique hotels.
- Launched a record-setting Black Friday/Cyber Monday campaign for The Kahala Hotel & Resort ($1.2M+) across paid media, email, and social.
- Built email automation (OTA winbacks, cancellation recovery, abandonment) to grow direct bookings.

Carat **Aug 2015 – Jun 2016**

Associate Media Director *New York, NY*

- Headed media planning and buying for MasterCard's U.S. consumer segment across digital and traditional channels, including the Internationalist Award–winning #STANDUP4.
- Partnered with global marketing and regional teams on culturally tailored, cross-market campaigns.
- Delivered quarterly business reviews that secured a 15% paid media budget increase.

Starcom MediaVest Group **Jun 2012 – Aug 2015**

Associate Media Director *New York, NY*

Promoted from Media Supervisor (Jun 2012 – Oct 2013)

- Led the integrated paid media team for Samsung Mobile USA on Cannes Lions and Effie-winning consumer and B2B campaigns.
- Directed U.S. media strategy and buying ($250M+ per quarter), national and local, across general-market and Hispanic campaigns.
- Drove paid media for the first-ever Oscars product integration, the Oscars Selfie: 3.4M+ retweets, $730M+ in earned media in 10 days, and +18% likelihood to recommend.
- Pioneered airport Wallhugger charging stations as a new OOH medium (416 placements, four airports): +4 pts awareness, −3 pts competitor preference.
- Planned the JAY Z *Magna Carta Holy Grail* sponsorship: 1M+ app downloads in 72 hours, +2.1% market share, and +3 pts brand preference.
- Grew Samsung Mobile's Facebook following from 6M to 23M in six months.

EDUCATION

University of South Florida

B.A., Mass Communications (Advertising) *Tampa, FL*

- Magna Cum Laude, with Honors; Zimmerman Advertising Program graduate

CORE COMPETENCIES

Integrated Marketing Strategy • Budget Ownership • Brand + Performance Media • Creative Direction
Photo & Video Direction • Partnerships • Cross-Functional Leadership • In-Market Expertise (Hawai'i)

AWARDS

- Cannes Lions – Gold: Branded Content & Entertainment; Silver: Oscars Selfie, 2014
- Effie Awards – Gold: Electronics; Silver: Media Idea, Electronics, 2015, 2014 & 2013
- Internationalist Awards – Gold, 2016 & 2014; Silver, 2014 (MasterCard, Samsung)
- Festival of Media – Gold (Samsung: Best Use of Programmatic Technology), 2015

PRESS

- Pacific Edge Magazine – Hospitality Spotlight interview on building 'Auana, 2026
- HI Now (KHNL) – TV segment from the Aloha Tokyo Festival, Shibuya, June 2026
- Travel Watch (Impress), Japan – Aloha Tokyo Festival coverage, June 2026